NCCP 00253 · VERSION 6

Tamoxifen · daily hormone therapy

Take tamoxifen once daily continuously. There is no planned week off. The prescriber confirms the duration for the treatment setting.

Make treatment fit into daily life

Swallow the tablet whole, with or without food. If a dose is missed or vomited, do not replace it; take the next scheduled daily dose.

Make one daily dose easier

Link the tablet to a regular daily routine. Ask the pharmacy for help with supply or swallowing difficulties. Do not double a dose to catch up.

Surgery, immobility and clot risk

Tell the surgical and oncology teams that you take tamoxifen. They decide whether any temporary interruption is needed; there is no automatic fixed interruption for everyone.

Bleeding and eye symptoms

Do not wait for an annual review to report unusual vaginal bleeding or visual disturbance. An annual gynaecological examination does not mean routine ultrasound or biopsy for an asymptomatic person.

Review all medicines

Include prescriptions, over-the-counter products and supplements. Some antidepressants can reduce conversion to the active metabolite; a prescriber should review any change.

Who arranges each check?

Agree the due window, booking team, result reviewer and whom to contact if an appointment or result is missing. This reference page does not book or record a test.

Sources and review

The NCCP regimen supplies the treatment rules. Separate guidelines supply the longer-term monitoring recommendations, with their qualifications retained.

- NCCP 00253 v6 · official regimen
- Tamoxifen manufacturer SmPC · emc
- EBCTCG: five years of adjuvant tamoxifen versus no tamoxifen
- ATLAS: continuing tamoxifen to ten years versus stopping at five years
- Pan-Asian adapted ESMO early breast cancer guidelines
- Pan-Asian adapted ESMO metastatic breast cancer guidelines
- NICE NG 101: early and locally advanced breast cancer
- ESO-ESMO ABC 5 consensus: tumour-marker interpretation
- ACOG Committee Opinion 601: tamoxifen and uterine cancer

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending